Animal Health, Welfare and Behaviour

Land Sciences

May, 2026

Ollscoil Teicneolaíochta an Oirdheiscirt
South East Technological University

Animal Health, Welfare and Behaviour (A07889)

Short Title: Animal Health, Welfare & Behav
Faculty Science and Computing
Department Land Sciences
Cluster Agriculture
Author SWALSH
Credits 5 **Level:** Advanced

Description of Module / Aims

The aim of this module is to provide students with an in-depth understanding of different physiological systems in the body. Students will learn about dysfunctions in these systems and how they relate to animal and herd health. Additionally, students will have an appreciation of the pathogenesis of economically important diseases, and the role of Animal Health Ireland in the control/eradication of disease. They will also have the ability to implement effective disease prevention and control measures. Students will also have an appreciation of the fundamentals of animal welfare and behaviour.

Programmes

AGRI-0107	BSc (Hons) in Agricultural Science (WD_SAGRI_B)	4 / 7 / M

Indicative Content

- Normal and abnormal physiological function of different systems in farm animals
- Pathologies of economically important diseases
- Animal welfare and behaviour
- Health management
- Biosecurity assessment of a site
- Economic implications of diseases at a farm and national level

Learning Outcomes

On successful completion of this module, a student will be able to:

1. Appraise and abnormal physiological status of various systems in farm animals.
2. Evaluate and discuss important concepts of animal welfare and behaviour.
3. Evaluate current and evolving herd health issues.
4. Assess the various disease diagnostics techniques available.
5. Assess herd health status and management practices and recommend effective disease prevention and control measures.
6. Evaluate the development of mastitis, SCC and benefits of Cellcheck -- the national mastitis control programme.
7. Evaluate the development of lameness and usefulness of locomotion scoring and hoof scoring as a management tool.
8. Prepare a report on a specified herd health issue.

Learning and Teaching Methods

- Lectures.
- Field trips.
- Guest industry speakers.

Assessment Methods

	Weighing		Outcomes Assessed
Final Written Examination	60%		1,2,3,4,5,6,7
Continuous Assessment	40%		
In-Class Assessment		20%	1,2,3,4,5,6,7
Project		20%	8

Assessment Criteria

<40%: Very limited knowledge and understanding of the subject matter.

40%-49%: Will be able to show a basic knowledge of the key learning outcomes, including a good understanding of herd health.

50%-59%: As well as the above, the student will be able to demonstrate a good understanding of the learning outcomes, as well as being able to describe and evaluate control measures to ensure effective biosecurity.

60%-69%: In addition, the student will demonstrate more detailed knowledge of all the topics, including how to evaluate the factors affecting animal health and homeostasis.

70%-100%: The student will be able to demonstrate a comprehensive knowledge and understanding of all learning outcomes, including the ability to fully integrate the various components of the course.

Learning Modes

Learning Mode	F/T Hours	P/T Hours
Lecture	30	
Field Trips	6	
Independent Learning	99	

Essential Material

- Babb, E.B. and L.C. Hare. _Animal Welfare : Select Issues and Management Considerations_. USA: Nova Science Publishers, Inc., 2013.
- Blowey, R.W. _A veterinary book for dairy farmers_. UK: Farming Press, 1998.
- Campbell, N.A., J.B. Reece, L.A. Urry, M.L. Cain, S.A. Wasserman and Minorsky, P.V., Jackson, R.B. _Biology_. USA: Pearson, 2008.

Supplementary Material

- "Animal Health Ireland." www.animalhealthireland.ie
- Wang, C., B. Kaltenboeck and M.D. Freeman. _Veterinary PCR diagnostics_ . USA: Bentham Science, 2012.